



find it more efficient to outsource all, or part of, the process (see pp.50–51) to maintain a high standard of customer service.

E-fulfillment companies help with online sales, handling everything from storage to dispatch. They can also tailor their services to your needs as a small business. If this seems like an attractive option, choose carefully, ensuring that the costs are manageable and that the company's values, services, and operation are a good fit with your brand.



NEED TO KNOW

- › **E-fulfillment** refers to the processes used by businesses to sell products or services online.
- › **Fulfillment management** is the overseeing of the ordering process, from the initial sales inquiry to the delivery of the product to the customer.
- › **Warehouse inventory** refers to all the goods and materials that will be for sale by the company.

60%
of people buy
from the online
retailer with the
best delivery
options

State of eCommerce Delivery Consumer
Research Report, MetaPack, 2017



Distribute or deliver the package

Choose an appropriate delivery method. If the customer is local, you can hand-deliver the item; if not, send it by post or courier. Valuable items require an insured shipping method or can be covered by a goods-in-transit insurance policy.

Notify customer

Notify the customer when the package ships and, if required, contact them on the day of delivery to confirm location, time frame, and any special instructions. The package should include instructions on how to return the item, if necessary.